

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ T 6 5 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ 3 2

♠ Q J T 7

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ 7 6 2

♣ K Q



♠ 5

♥ J 3

♦ K Q 5 4 3

♣ 9 8 6 5 4

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ A 7

♦ J T 9

♣ A J T 7

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1♥. Partner replies 1♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6

♥ 8 5 4

♦ J 4 3

♣ J T 2

♠ K T 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ 7 3 2

♥ A Q 3 2

♦ T 5

♣ Q 8 7 4

♠ A J 5

♥ K T 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 6 4
♥ 9 7 2
♦ T 9 5 3
♣ A T 9

♠ A K 9 2
♥ J 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 8 3 2



♠ Q 7 5
♥ A 8 4 3
♦ J 8 4
♣ 7 6 4

♠ T 8 3
♥ K Q T 6
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q J 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1 ♥. Partner says 1 ♠.

Partner doesn't have 4 ♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8 6
 ♥ Q 6 3 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ Q 6 4 3 2

♠ A 7
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ K J 9 7 4
 ♣ J T 8 5



♠ J 5 4 2
 ♥ J 7 5
 ♦ A 8 5 2
 ♣ K 7

♠ K T 9 3
 ♥ A T 8 4
 ♦ Q T 3
 ♣ A 9

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

You have great ♦ support and perhaps 15 points. The "perhaps" is because partner may have only 3 ♦s, and if you are the long-trump hand any ruffs you take will probably not increase the number of trump tricks your side makes. But still, you have a great hand.

So you bid 3 ♦. Partner now says 3NT.

You described your hand very well with your first bid. Partner heard the description and chose 3NT. Since you trust your partner you pass.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4 2
♥ A J T 6 2
♦ 9 7 2
♣ J 4

♠ A K 6 3

♥ K 9

♦ A 8 3

♣ Q 9 7 5



♠ T 7

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 4

♣ A T 3

♠ J 9 8 5

♥ Q 7 4

♦ T 5

♣ K 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

You must make a weak response, and in theory there are 3 weak responses you could make with this hand. You could bid 2 ♣, 1 ♠ or 1NT. And while none of them would be actually incorrect the best choice is to show your 4-card Major.

You bid 1 ♠. Partner jumps to 3 ♠.

You started with just 6 points, and after discovering the ♠ fit you revalue all the way up to 7 points. Partner has shown 16-18 and that's still not enough for game. You pass.

Board 6

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 5 2
♥ J 5 4
♦ 9 8 3 2
♣ K 4

♠ A 9 3
♥ A T 8 3
♦ K Q J 6
♣ Q J



♠ K Q 7 6
♥ 6 2
♦ 7 4
♣ A 9 7 5 3

♠ 8 4
♥ K Q 9 7
♦ A T 5
♣ T 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Your top priority as responder is to show a Major suit if you have one, so you say 1♥. Partner jumps to 3♥.

Partner knows you may have only 6 points and went to the 3-level anyway. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a bit more than the 6 you promised. You revalue up to 10 so you have quite a bit more. You accept his invitation and bid 4♥.